The Dead and the Missing of the Epstein Orbit

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A complete anatomy of every death, disappearance, and debunked list surrounding the Epstein case — with every claim labeled by the strength of its evidence and every gap named rather than filled.

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Compiled October 21, 2026, from eighteen research dives and 23,500 words of tier-tagged notes. This document adopts no theory. It presents the record — what is proven, what is alleged, what is disputed, and what remains unknown — in the order a reader would need to understand it. The dead are treated with the same discipline as the living: no death is called murder without evidence, and no ruling is called final where the record contradicts it.

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How to Read This Document

Three tools, used throughout.

The tier system. *S-tier* means a primary document — a coroner ruling, a court record, an autopsy, a congressional record, an official report. *A-tier* means reporting by a major outlet quoting or linking those documents. *B-tier* means credible reporting that paraphrases without full sourcing. *C-tier* means a single-source or contested claim, always flagged. Where finer distinctions matter, three labels appear inside the text: *T1* for a documented fact, *T2* for an attributed claim or clearly-labeled analysis, and *T3* for speculation or debunked material, retained because even false claims are evidence — of pressure, incentives, or fog.

The categories. Every person in this document is filed in one of eight: custody deaths; confirmed and adjudicated deaths; unsolved deaths and disappearances; contested rulings; the Belgian trilogy; the Franklin file; explained deaths; the missing;

the living under threat; and the debunked. The categories matter because they prevent the single fatal error of this subject — treating a ruled suicide, an unsolved murder, and a debunked rumor as the same kind of event.

The rule. Collect clues, don't adopt theories. Where a ruling is disputed, both the ruling and the dispute are presented with their documents. Where a claim collapsed, the collapse is documented with the same care as the claim. Nothing here is overstated, because the dead cannot correct the record and the living can.

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Part I — The Two Custody Deaths

Two men died in custody awaiting trial on the same charges: one in New York in August 2019, one in Paris in February 2022. Both were ruled suicide. Both rulings are contested in public, and neither has been disproven. Both men were held, at the time of their deaths, in facilities that had already failed them in documented ways. The two files, taken together, are the most complete custody-death records in modern history — and they point in opposite directions.

Chapter 1: Jeffrey Epstein

The documented sequence of August 2019 is reconstructed elsewhere in the companion research; what belongs here is the death itself and the file it left.

At approximately 6:30 AM on Saturday, August 10, 2019, Jeffrey Epstein was found in his cell at the Metropolitan Correctional Center in Manhattan, unresponsive, with an orange string — "presumably from a sheet or a shirt," in the Inspector General's later words — tied to the top of his bunk, his body in a near-seated position an inch and a half off the floor. He was pronounced dead at a Manhattan hospital. The city medical examiner ruled the manner suicide by hanging. A pathologist retained by Epstein's brother disputed the finding, citing the fracture pattern; the fingerprints matched; no third-party DNA claim has ever been supported.

The procedural record, assembled across nineteen months of releases, is the largest ever compiled for a custody death: the adjacent camera had not recorded since July 29, ten days before, and no one noticed. Epstein spent thirty-one hours on suicide watch after the July 23 incident and was then removed. His cellmate of August 1-9 was released through court process at 1:50 PM on August 9, recorded in a staff memo, and no replacement cellmate ever came. Fourteen inmate interviews, recovered from handwritten agent notes, record that one inmate warned guards on the August 9 elevator that Epstein would kill himself, and heard the response: "He's going to kill himself no matter what... we don't care either way. Let him kill himself." Every institutional count that night — the four, ten, midnight, three, and five o'clock rounds — was signed without being performed, confirmed against video. Between approximately 10:30 PM and 6:33 AM, no one approached his tier at all: an eight-hour gap. One of the two officers on duty falsified more

than seventy-five separate round entries; both slept roughly two hours; one browsed furniture websites, the other motorcycle listings. The grand jury voted to indict both on six counts; both later entered deferred-prosecution agreements of one hundred hours of community service; the charges were dismissed in January 2022. Neither was convicted.

The Justice Department's Inspector General report, June 27, 2023, found thirteen employees failed in their duties — and simultaneously closed the criminal question: "we did not uncover evidence contradicting the FBI's determination there was no criminality in connection with how Epstein died." Three inmates with direct lines of sight and the staff on duty saw no one enter. A purported suicide note surfaced through his July cellmate, tucked in a graphic novel, unauthenticated by any agency, reading in part: "They investigated me for months — found nothing!!! It is a treat to be able to choose one's time to say goodbye." A second note surfaced in 2026; three handwriting examiners found both notes shared an author, and none could name the author, because the millions of released pages contain no confirmed exemplar of Epstein's handwriting [S-tier: DOJ OIG; A-tier: AP, Baden, Vastrick].

Two documented anomalies remain open. An attorney for Epstein deposited funds into his final cellmate's commissary account "for unknown reasons," in the Bureau of Prisons' own reconstruction — a thread traced across eight dives of research and connected by no sourced account to anything. And the cellmate himself, Efrain Reyes, died of COVID-19 in November 2020, at his mother's Bronx apartment, after being interviewed

by the FBI and personally by the Attorney General; a source close to him contacted the Daily News specifically, in the paper's words, "to dispel conspiracy theories" [S-tier].

The December 2023 Bureau of Prisons reform memorandum, system-wide, cites the lapses "like those that allowed financier Jeffrey Epstein's 2019 death" as the template for national reform. That is the official final word: no one killed him, and the system that could not keep him alive has been documented, employee by employee, hour by hour, as the most comprehensively failed custody in the modern record. Whether the failure was accumulation or design is the question the file poses and does not answer — a panel presentation at University College London in November 2026, and a brother-funded review, keep the medical dispute alive, both at their documented weight [S/T1 as tagged].

Chapter 2: Jean-Luc Brunel

The French file is shorter and, in its way, starker.

Jean-Luc Brunel, the modeling agent whom prosecutors called a co-conspirator, died on February 19, 2022, in La Santé Prison in Paris, found hanging in his cell between one and one-thirty in the morning. He was alone; the cell had no camera; the ruling was suicide, confirmed by a March 2023 inquiry. He was seventy-five.

The documented pattern preceding the death: multiple suicide attempts across fourteen months, confirmed by his own lawyer; a brief release after a Christmas attempt, then re-jailing days later on appeal; no active suicide watch, because France's

emergency-protection cells operate for twenty-four hours only; placement in the wing reserved for vulnerable prisoners; four to six nightly checks confirmed against corridor video [S/A-tier].

The context layer, preserved because it is documented: he died two months after Maxwell's conviction and days after a settlement between Prince Andrew and Virginia Giuffre, while a New York judge was weighing the unsealing of the Giuffre civil files. The reaction quotes are on the record — a victims' attorney calling the timing "a hell of a coincidence… almost like someone is trying to send a message to Ghislaine to shut up," his bookkeeper saying "somebody probably killed Jean-Luc, too," his accusers numbering eleven with accounts spanning decades. And the counterweight: a fourteen-month documented self-harm history that makes the ruling medically unremarkable. In February 2026, French authorities reopened their examination of his case after the American file releases listed him among the FBI's named co-conspirators [S/A-tier].

The two custody deaths, taken together: one with an exonerating video record and thirteen documented failures, one with no camera and a documented mental-health file. The first has the better-documented innocence of outsiders and the worse-documented machinery; the second has the better-documented machinery and the worse-documented innocence. Both rulings stand. Both are contested by serious people. Neither contest has produced evidence [T2 — framing; facts S/A-tier].

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Part II — The Confirmed and the Adjudicated

Five violent deaths in this orbit are not mysteries. They are solved, or their perpetrators are named and convicted, or their mechanisms are documented end to end. They belong here first because they anchor everything else: they prove what a documented death looks like, so the contested ones can be weighed against a real standard.

Chapter 3: Arthur Shapiro — The Confirmed Unsolved Murder

On the morning of March 6, 1985, Arthur Shapiro, forty-three, tax counsel to The Limited and to Les Wexner personally, was shot twice in the head at close range while driving his red BMW in Columbus, Ohio, after leaving what police described as a cemetery breakfast meeting. He was weeks from testifying before a federal grand jury investigating sham tax shelters. The case has never been solved. It is the only confirmed murder in this entire document where the victim's death is directly tied to testimony against an empire that would later fund everything else in this book [S/B-tier: Columbus Dispatch 25-year retrospective; Daily Beast].

The prime suspect, documented across twenty-five years of detective work: Berry L. Kessler, the accountant who had helped Shapiro build the shelters and who had motive — a cooperating Shapiro meant prison. The lead detective, James McCoskey, said on the record: "I think there is a direct connection between

Berry Kessler and the Shapiro homicide… There is a connection, but nothing we could take to court." Kessler's employees saw a man matching the killer's description visit his office the day after the murder; he was seen counting a large pile of money before the visitor arrived [B-tier].

The Kessler pattern — the reason this file stays open — is documented seriality. Kessler died in 2005 in federal prison at eighty-four, having been convicted of murder-for-hire against business partner John Deroo and of plotting the death of Perce Yankey, with life-insurance policies on both. He was suspected, never charged, in the 1970 double murder of business partner Frank Yassenoff and his fiancée Ella Rich; another partner, Marjorie Dyer, died in a car accident on a will he co-signed. At the Deroo sentencing, the judge told him: "You are, in fact, a clever, cunning and merciless killer" [B-tier, court-record-sourced].

The Epstein thread is a sequence, not a claim: Wexner's tax counsel was murdered in March 1985; Jeffrey Epstein took over the management of Wexner's finances in the years immediately following — the position that became the foundation of his power, documented from the first research. Shapiro's name appeared decades later in an FBI file involving Epstein's activities, per the Daily Beast's reporting. No document connects the murder to Epstein, and none connects it to Wexner. What the sequence documents is a vacancy at the top of Wexner's financial world, created by a bullet, filled by the man whose case this book surrounds [T1: the sequence; T2: its significance].

And one more documented fact that keeps the file warm: in 1996, Columbus Police Chief James Jackson was charged with improper disposal of a public record for ordering the destruction of a crime-analyst report on the Shapiro homicide — a report that, per the civil-service proceeding that upheld the charge, "speculated that millionaire businessmen in Columbus and Youngstown were linked to the 'mob-style murder'" [B-tier].

Chapter 4: Barry Seal — The Adjudicated Assassination

Barry Seal was shot to death on February 19, 1986, in the parking lot of the Salvation Army halfway house in Baton Rouge, Louisiana, where a federal judge had sentenced him to spend his nights. Three Colombian hitmen — Luis Quintero-Cruz the shooter, with Hernan Velez and José Vásquez — were convicted of first-degree murder and sentenced to life without parole; the Medellin cartel had posted a five-hundred-thousand-dollar bounty on him, dead or a million alive, after his role as a Drug Enforcement Administration informant became known — a role the government itself exposed by leaking his Nicaragua surveillance photos. Quintero-Cruz apologized at his clemency hearing in January 2023; the denial came down; Velez died in Angola custody in August 2026. The assassination is solved, adjudicated, and closed [S-tier: trial record; UALR Barry Seal Collection].

The documented failure beneath the adjudication: a federal judge, Frank Polozola, read the halfway house's address aloud in open court, placing the DEA's most valuable informant — under

a live, publicly known bounty — in a fixed, unprotected location, unarmed. Louisiana's attorney general criticized the failure to protect him; a 1988 House Judiciary hearing examined whether Oliver North's circle had leaked the operation for political gain. Seal flew for Southern Air Transport, the CIA-linked airline whose crews and aircraft thread through the Iran-Contra record and whose corporate remnant the companion research ties to a cocaine interdiction and the Wexner orbit. That thread is documented at every node; what it means is the reader's to weigh, as this document's rule requires [S-tier: the assassination; T2: the thread].

Chapter 5: The Solved Ones

Three more violent deaths in the wider orbit are solved with named, sentenced perpetrators, and are recorded here so the ledger is honest about what resolution looks like.

Marielle Franco, the Rio de Janeiro councilwoman and police-militia critic, was assassinated on March 14, 2018. In October 2024, Brazil's courts sentenced the gunmen Ronnie Lessa and Élcio de Queiroz, the Brazão brothers who commissioned the killing — one a federal congressman — and, in the detail that matters for this document's pattern analysis, the former police investigator Rivaldo Barbosa, convicted of sabotaging the case from within. The case was solved only after a change of administration, five years on; the institutional-betrayal detail is the documented template for how investigations die without conspiracies [S-tier: AP, October 2024].

Linda Collins-Smith, the former Arkansas state senator, was stabbed to death in May 2019. Her former campaign aide and friend, Rebecca O'Donnell, pleaded guilty in August 2020: "I intentionally killed her and then hid the body" — forty-three years. The motive was financial, documented through the family: money taken and a confrontation. The claim layer that survived her — that she was killed for investigating state trafficking — is preserved as a claim, with its genealogy traced in Part X [S-tier].

Daniel Anderl, twenty, the only child of Judge Esther Salas, was shot through the door of their New Jersey home on July 19, 2020, by a gunman in a FedEx uniform, dying shielding his parents. The perpetrator, Roy Den Hollander, killed himself the next day; he had murdered the lawyer Marc Angelucci in California eight days earlier, then drove to the Catskills where he was found dead of a self-inflicted shot, a FedEx envelope addressed to the judge in the car. The case is solved with a dead perpetrator. What keeps it in this document is the documented context: four days before the killing, Judge Salas had been randomly assigned a class action against Deutsche Bank alleging it failed to monitor high-risk clients including Jeffrey Epstein; Maxwell had been arrested seventeen days before; the gunman had worked years earlier at Kroll Associates' Moscow office, the intelligence-linked investigations firm. The official motive — a personal grudge from a case he had lost before her — explains the target; the four-day precision and the employment history are documented facts that the record leaves adjacent to, not connected to, the Epstein case. Both halves are preserved [S-tier: the homicide; T1: the timing and employment;

T2: the open question].

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Part III — The Unsolved

Four deaths and three disappearances in this orbit are genuinely unsolved — no perpetrator convicted, no mechanism established to the satisfaction of the investigators. Each is documented here with what is known, what is claimed, and what the claims cannot carry.

Chapter 6: Gary Caradori

On July 11, 1990, Gary Caradori, forty-one, the investigator for the Nebraska Legislature's Franklin Committee, died when his six-seat Piper disintegrated in flight near Ashton, Illinois, returning from the All-Star Game in Chicago with his eight-year-old son, Andrew. The wreckage scattered over three-quarters of a mile. The National Transportation Safety Board found no evidence of sabotage; the engine was producing normally. No definitive cause has ever been established [S-tier: NTSB; A: Wikipedia].

The quotes that keep the file open are on the record. Caradori had told the committee chairman, State Senator Loran Schmit — a forty-year pilot — that the investigation "could put the lives of some people in danger." After the crash, Schmit said: "There is no doubt in my mind that some people wanted to see Caradori dead. They got their wish. The question to be answered is whether it was a coincidence." His wife: "Gary was so careful in

his flying habits." The FBI was notified; it did not participate [S-tier: contemporaneous record].

The context is documented and double-edged. Caradori had videotaped three abuse witnesses in the Franklin investigation — the Omaha credit-union failure and the child-abuse allegations that a grand jury would later call "a carefully crafted hoax," convicting two witnesses of perjury. The official history treats his crash as an accident and the case as fabrication. This document holds both: the crash facts, and the discredited-case record, because both are the record. A fresh revisit, "Unsilenced: Franklin, Epstein, and the Patterns That Protect the Powerful," appeared in Omaha Magazine in March 2026, treating Franklin as pattern precedent [S/A-tier].

Chapter 7: Jill Dando

On April 26, 1999, Jill Dando, thirty-seven, the presenter of BBC's *Crimewatch*, was shot once in the head at close range with a silenced nine-millimeter pistol on her own doorstep in Fulham, at 11:32 in the morning. The killing had the marks of a professional execution. A local man, Barry George, was convicted in 2001 and acquitted in 2008 when the forensic particle evidence was discredited. The murder is unsolved [S-adjacent: the murder documented; theories B/C-tier].

Three theories carry the file. The first, and the one that reaches this orbit, holds that Dando had compiled a dossier on a BBC pedophile ring and had warned bosses that "big name" stars were implicated — a claim sourced to a single anonymous figure in a 2014 tabloid report, with no documentary

corroboration, no leaked dossier, and no inquiry reference; its thinness is itself documented. The second, with court-paper backing of a kind: French court documents in the Gerald Marie case — Marie being the Elite Models chief of Brunel's world — allege that Marie hired a Russian hitman to kill Lisa Brinkworth, an ex-model journalist investigating Elite, and that the hitman mistook Dando, same blonde, Fulham, BBC, for Brinkworth. Metropolitan Police: unsubstantiated. The third: the IRA, named in 2015 police documents as having monitored her, dismissed for lack of claim and ballistics match. The murder is real, professional, and open; the theories are preserved at their weights, and the modeling-world adjacency — Elite, scouting, the lattice documented elsewhere in this record — is the only thread that touches this case's central subject, and it is a thread, not a finding [A/C-tier as tagged].

Chapter 8: The Paperboy

Johnny Gosch was twelve years old on the morning of September 5, 1982, when he vanished between six and seven o'clock on his Sunday paper route in West Des Moines, Iowa. His wagon was found full of papers two blocks from home. Two other paperboys saw him talking to a stocky man in a blue two-tone car; a neighbor heard a door slam and saw a silver Ford Fairmont speed away. He has never been found. Forty-four years [S-tier: NCMEC; the foundational American missing-child case].

The institutional failure is documented and was nationally consequential: police treated him as a runaway; the

seventy-two-hour delay in response — the Gosch case, with Eugene Martin's, a thirteen-year-old who vanished on the same route, same paper, same method, in August 1984 — drove the Johnny Gosch Bill (Iowa, 1984: immediate police response), the milk-carton campaign, and the federal Missing Children Act signed by Reagan in October 1982. A third boy, Marc Allen, thirteen, disappeared in March 1986. All three cases are open. John Walsh, who built an institution from his own son's murder, has said: "I always believed there was a serial pedophile kidnapper in that area" [S/A-tier].

The claims layer is preserved in full, because this file is where the private-investigation world documented in this record does its deepest work. A convicted sex offender, Paul Bonacci, told the Franklin author John DeCamp in 1989 that he had been forced to participate in the kidnapping; he described Johnny's chest birthmark (publicized) but also the tongue scar, the lower-leg burn scar, and the stammer — details that were not public, which the mother, Noreen Gosch, said he could know only from her son. His siblings told police he was home that morning; the FBI never credited him; the family alibi interviews happened almost a decade later, and the West Des Moines detective told CNN in 2023 that police had ruled Bonacci out too quickly and would talk to him today if they could. Bonacci testified under oath in a case that produced a one-million-dollar default judgment against a Franklin figure — a procedural ruling, not a factual finding, and his diagnosis of dissociative identity disorder is on the record. A foreknowledge claim — that Bonacci was told in advance of "the second weekend in August

1984, a paperboy from the southside" — preceded Eugene Martin's identical abduction; the source of the foreknowledge denied saying it. The National Center for Missing and Exploited Children tried to form a task force linking the three disappearances; the West Des Moines police refused to cooperate, per the mother's account. A fraudster, Robert Meier, extorted eleven thousand dollars with false promises; a batch of photographs left at a doorstep was tied by a Florida detective to a 1978-1980 abuse series, though one boy was never identified; the mother maintains a visit from an adult Johnny in 1997, which the father doubts. Retired NYPD trafficking investigator Jim Rothstein and retired FBI Los Angeles chief Ted Gunderson worked the case privately — the same Gunderson who appears in the Franklin file and the Boner death file. Every claim is preserved with its counter, and the case stays open [S/A/B-tier as tagged; the network of investigators documented as a network, its claims as claims].

Chapter 9: Seth Rich

Seth Rich, twenty-seven, was shot twice in the back at 4:19 in the morning on July 10, 2016, near his home in Washington's Bloomingdale neighborhood. His wallet, phone, and watch were on his body; nothing was taken. The case is unsolved; the police ruling is a botched robbery, in a neighborhood that had seen a robbery spike [S-tier: the murder].

Everything built on the murder collapsed, and the collapse is documented end to end. Three days after the killing — nine days before WikiLeaks published the Democratic National Committee

emails the theory claimed he leaked — a website run by the persona Sorcha Faal published the first story: an "SVR report" claiming Rich was lured to a fake FBI meeting and killed by a Russian hit team. The theory preceded the event it explained. From there the chain is documented hop by hop: the list-site whatreallyhappened.com, WorldNetDaily, Roger Stone and Jerome Corsi and Kim Dotcom, Fox News in May 2017, prime-time television. Robert Mueller's investigation established the emails came from Russian military intelligence and assessed that Julian Assange's insinuations about Rich were a disinformation effort to obscure the source. Fox retracted within a week and later settled with the parents; the Washington Times retracted and apologized to Rich's brother; Corsi formally retracted and apologized; a D.C. police officer was documented accessing the case file and leaking the sole witness's name to a podcaster. The family: "We lost his body the first time, and the second time we lost his soul." The murder is real, open, and unconnected — on the present record — to anything in this document's central subject. The theory built on it is the template case of the misattribution industry: a real death, a pre-built narrative, a disinformation seed, and a family's lawsuit as the only correction mechanism [S/A-tier: the genealogy].

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Part IV — The Contested Rulings

Some deaths carry rulings that the record itself does not fully support — documented anomalies, forensic conflicts, or

sequences in which an official conclusion sits uneasily beside its own paperwork. These are presented as what they are: unresolved, with both halves of each file open on the table.

Chapter 10: Philip Marshall

Philip Marshall, fifty-four, a former Eastern and United Airlines captain who described himself as a contract pilot for CIA and DEA "special activities" during Iran-Contra — including flights for Barry Seal — was found dead with his seventeen-year-old son Alex, his fourteen-year-old daughter Macaila, and the family dog, in their Murphys, California home, between January 31 and February 2, 2013. The Calaveras County Sheriff ruled murder-suicide and closed the case in days. The children were found on the couch; Marshall by a nine-millimeter Glock. There was no note [S-tier: the rulings; the anomalies documented].

The documented conflicts: a first-witness account places the entrance wound on the left side of the head — Marshall was strictly right-handed, per friends who threw baseballs and footballs with him — while the sheriff's press release said the right side and misspelled his name throughout. Neighbors in the close-set mountain community heard no gunshots. The children's last texts, on Thursday night, were entirely normal. The sheriff closed the case before toxicology returned. The local paper and a county supervisor said on the record: "The actions don't match the person we know." The wife was out of the country; one researcher account adds that she was in Istanbul the same week an American photographer's beaten body was found there, and

that the couple had traveled to Turkey together weeks earlier — the travel facts require primary confirmation, and the inference built on them is the researcher's [S/A-tier: the conflicts; NA-tier: the travel layer].

The research layer is Marshall's own documented record: three books, including a 9/11 investigation drawing on Iran-Contra principals; a November 2012 radio appearance in which he said he had "shocking new information" about the CIA's Marana airfield and the hijackers' training; a planned fourth book; a statement to friends that he "had to watch his back." One researcher who walked the scene declared himself "one hundred percent certain" of a black-ops hit made to look like murder-suicide — a claimed certainty, not evidence [A/NA-tier as tagged].

Chapter 11: Philip Haney

Philip Haney, sixty-six, a founding Department of Homeland Security officer and whistleblower on the scrubbing of terrorism-screening records, was found dead of a gunshot on February 21, 2020, in Amador County, California. He was planning a second book, he said, to name names; the manuscript lived on a thumb drive he carried. The case is officially closed as suicide. The closure sits uneasily beside its own paperwork [S-adjacent: the ruling; the forensic conflict documented].

The documented conflict: the forensic pathologist, Dr. Katherine Raven, signed the case out as a homicide autopsy — a perforating gunshot wound to the torso, consistent with contact range, with an exit wound on the left side of the back and

abrasions on both knees; a contact-range shot producing a back exit wound is a physically awkward self-infliction. Nine months later, a deputy coroner's amendment recorded "apparent self-inflicted gunshot wound," and the new sheriff — a graduate of the FBI National Academy — closed the case. The note matched his handwriting; the gun traced to him; he gave away his potted plants the day before; the FBI's crime-scene analysts assisted. And the FBI's analysis of his seized phone, laptop, thumb drives, and documents — promised within weeks in 2020 — has never been released, five years on. Two members of Congress publicly disputed suicide. Both halves are the record [S/T1 as tagged].

Chapter 12: Sabrina Bittencourt

Sabrina Bittencourt, thirty-eight, the Brazilian-born investigator whose January 2019 video accusing the faith healer João de Deus of running "baby farms" — teenage slaves producing children for a decade, then killed — drove the arrest that produced a three-hundred-and-seventy-year sentence, died in February 2019, reportedly in Barcelona, reportedly by suicide, reportedly leaving a farewell letter announced by the victims' organization she led. Her eldest son confirmed the death and wrote: "They killed my mother" [A-tier: CJR; B-tier: the rest].

The record itself is the anomaly. No death certificate, body, autopsy, burial, or consular document has ever been publicly produced, across two claimed countries — the reports said Spain, her son said Lebanon, the discrepancy never explained.

She had survived a previous fake report of her own death. People close to her, including her first husband, speculated she staged it. The day before she died, she sent a message to a journalist naming her persecutor and stating that a guide at the compound had marked "professional killers" to find her; she feared her children's address had been discovered. Her final public post joined the murdered councilwoman Marielle Franco: "Sorry for not being able to bear it, my children." Officially suicide; the death record unverifiable as published; the threats documented [A/B-tier as tagged].

Chapter 13: The Researcher Cluster

Four researchers and investigators died carrying open files, each at a different documented weight.

Danny Casolaro, forty-four, was found in the bathtub of his Martinsburg, West Virginia hotel room on August 10, 1991, his wrists slashed a dozen times, investigating the Inslaw software affair and the network he called the Octopus. He had warned his brother not to believe a suicide ruling; his papers were never found; the room was cleaned before his family was notified; the body was embalmed without permission. Two autopsies ruled suicide; he had early-stage multiple sclerosis and drugs in his system. In 2024, documents obtained by filmmakers contradicted the original police statement — a witness had seen another man visit the room, and the police sketch matched a former military-intelligence officer, Joseph Cuellar, whose specialty, per his son, was infiltrating, extracting what someone knew, and psychological warfare. The House Judiciary

Committee sought an independent counsel; the Justice Department declined in 1994. One correspondent's counter-theory — that Casolaro staged his death as murder so others would chase the story — remains on the record, unrebutted and unproven [S/A-tier].

Nikolai Mushegian, twenty-nine, tweeted at 4:57 AM on October 28, 2022 — that the CIA, Mossad, and a pedophile elite ran a sex-trafficking blackmail ring out of Puerto Rico, that they would frame him with a planted laptop, that they would torture him to death — and was found drowned by a surfer at 9:15 AM, four hours and eighteen minutes later, fully clothed, wallet on him, at Condado beach, a spot with posted riptide warnings that had taken at least eight lives the year before. San Juan's homicide division and a prosecutor investigated; the family did not suspect foul play; Rune Christensen, the founder of his cryptocurrency world, said his mother had clarified the death had nothing to do with the tweets, and that if the government were killing crypto pioneers, "I would know." He had spoken with federal agencies; one source said some of his paranoia "was based on fact... he knew things." He was a strong swimmer, three hundred yards from his six-million-dollar home, four days after a 1.6-billion-dollar vote he had opposed. The ruling is accidental drowning; the window, the tweet, and the contact are documented; murder is unproven [S/A-tier].

Natacha Jaitt, forty-one, posted in April 2018 — weeks after naming a child-prostitution ring reaching politicians and Gustavo Vera, a close friend of Pope Francis — "I am not going to commit suicide... if that happens, IT WASN'T ME. Save this

tweet." She was found dead eleven months later at the Xanadú party salon outside Buenos Aires, naked on a bed, five men present, cocaine residue in her nostrils and an official ruling of multi-organ failure from cocaine and alcohol. The documented contradictions: official blood tests reportedly did not confirm cocaine in her bloodstream; her brother said she was lucid and died in twenty-one minutes; a man who moved her phone at the scene was arrested for false testimony; eighteen days before, she told a journalist her health was "extremely fragile"; she had been recruited by Argentine intelligence, which cuts both ways; her file was shelved in 2024 and the family's reopen request refused in 2025. Argentine media documented it all; the ruling stands; the family calls it murder [S/A-tier as tagged].

Max Spiers, thirty-nine, died in Warsaw in July 2016 of pneumonia compounded by a drug overdose — ten Turkish Xanax tablets bought over the counter and oxycodone at potentially fatal levels, taken by a man with a long-documented addiction. The coroner ruled; his mother took closure from the inquest. The coroner also delivered a documented finding that survives the verdict: the Polish police were "wholly incompetent" — officers arrived at 6:30 PM, were due off-duty at seven, made no examination, interviewed no one, never notified the prosecutor, never secured the scene; had there been criminal involvement, "valuable time would have been lost and evidence contaminated." The UFO-conspiracy community that made him a martyr rejects the ruling; the medical record is the record [S-tier].

And **Jonathan Nichols**, the Oklahoma state senator found with a gunshot wound to the chest on June 5, 2019 — the same week as Linda Collins-Smith's murder three hundred miles east — whose affidavit documented the firearm in an "unexpected position," on a table across the room, before the self-inflicted ruling. The pairing is pattern material, examined in Part XIII; the individual ruling, with its documented anomaly, stands here [S-tier].

The third senator completes the cluster's shape. **Nancy Schaefer**, seventy-three, a former Georgia state senator and the author of a self-published exposé of child-protective services corruption, was shot in the back in her home on March 26, 2010; her husband then killed himself beside her, and the ruling was murder-suicide, the Georgia Bureau of Investigation's documented motive financial. Her allies rejected the ruling and folded her into the lists; the financial record and the bureau's finding are the documented half. Three senators, three documented shapes: one financial murder with a named killer, one murder-suicide with a documented financial frame, one across-the-room gun anomaly — the cluster the lists inflate into a pattern is, at the documented level, three different events the list-ecosystem needed to be one [S/A-tier].

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Chapter 13b: Robert Maxwell

Robert Maxwell, sixty-eight, disappeared from his yacht, the Lady Ghislaine — named for his daughter — off the Canary

Islands in the early hours of November 5, 1991, after a 4:25 AM call to the bridge asking that the air conditioning be turned off; his naked body was found floating that afternoon. What followed was not one autopsy but three verdicts, each with an interested party attached, and the entire sequence is S-tier documented.

The Tenerife autopsy found no seawater in the lungs and concluded he died of a heart attack. The Israeli examination thought heart attack compounded by drowning. The British pathologist commissioned by the insurers, Dr. Iain West, found no heart attack at all — torn and bleeding muscles at the back of the left shoulder, consistent with a man alive in the water, hanging by one arm from the yacht's rail trying to save himself — and concluded he fell, and drowned. The Spanish organs were never re-examined; the body was embalmed in Spain under family pressure before any independent examination could occur. The captain reported the cabin door locked from the outside — "how had he planned to get back in?" The nightshirt was never found; the body was not shriveled or sunburned [S/A-tier: the contemporaneous record; B: the anomalies].

The verdict that mattered most was the insurers'. The thirty-five-million-dollar life policy paid only on accident. Lloyd's of London commissioned its own investigation and concluded it was suicide — the empire was two billion dollars in debt, the Mirror pension plunder four hundred million pounds stolen from pensioners, the Bank of England meeting on the default skipped for the sailing — and denied the claim. The inquest had delivered heart attack and accidental drowning; the insurers delivered suicide; the family's acknowledged financial stake in

the accident finding sat beneath both. Three official-adjacent verdicts, three interested parties, and the one determination that could have settled the medical question — a re-examination of the Spanish organs — never happened [S-tier: the NYT record].

The anomalies and the lore are preserved at their weights: the funeral on the Mount of Olives attended by the Israeli prime minister and president and, by the documented count, at least six serving and former heads of Israeli intelligence; his daughter Ghislaine telling Vanity Fair the family suspected murder while her mother could not see suicide — "Bob was a fighter"; the CIA's private finding, per a correspondent's source, that he was not murdered but fell after a seizure; the body-double escape theory the Guardian called world-class bunk; the Mossad assassination theory his debts and his funeral fed. His biographer's verdict: Britain's consensus held it suicide, and he knew he faced jail. The insurance company agreed. The pathologist who examined him did not. The inquest did not. The file remains what three disagreeing verdicts make it — officially closed, substantively open [S/A/B-tier as tagged].

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Part V — The Belgian Trilogy

One country, three files, thirty documented deaths in a witness table, and a through-line that runs from a 1970s fascist militia to a fake Austrian passport found in a Manhattan safe in 2019. Belgium contributes more documented material to this

subject than any nation except the United States, and its official verdicts sit in permanent unease beside its own paperwork.

Chapter 14: The Thirty Witnesses

Between 1995 and 2004, approximately thirty people connected to the investigation of Marc Dutroux — the electrician convicted of abducting and raping six girls and murdering four — died. The tally comes from a German television documentary, Piet Eekman's "Dutroux und die toten Zeugen," broadcast in 2001 and 2004 and, in documented fact, never broadcast in Belgium; and from a book by the investigative journalist Douglas De Coninck, whose title is the claim itself: "Dead Witnesses — Thirty People Who Will Not Speak at the Dutroux Trial" [A-tier: Wikipedia, each entry footnoted; the ZDF/De Coninck sourcing named].

The table, in its most documented form: Jean-Paul Taminiau, the garage renter opposite Dutroux's house, whose foot was found in a river in April 1995 and whose body was never recovered. Alexandre Gosselin, who had sold his house to Dutroux's accomplice and slept with a gun under his pillow, dead of "natural causes" after abdominal pain that July. François Reyskens, whose foster son had met two of the victims in a Maastricht bar and who was killed by a train two hours before his scheduled police meeting on July 26, 1995 — his adoptive father, on the record: "It's rather strange that just at that moment he ends up under a train. Is it really a coincidence?" The gendarme Guy Goebels, found the day he was due to brief the press, gun in one hand and the telephone receiver in the

other. The policeman Simon Poncelet, shot in his office during a night shift — the cameras were not working that night — his death an unsolved murder per the New York Times; his father, a judge, called the cluster "opportune deaths." And on through the list: the scrap dealer Bruno Tagliaferro, poisoned, declared a suicide before the autopsy could say otherwise, among the first officers on scene a policeman in documented collusion with Dutroux's car ring; his widow Fabienne Jaupart, who had found her husband's papers and applied for police protection — granted by the judge who recognized foul play, suspended when that judge was replaced, and months later burnt alive on a methanol-soaked bed, ruled suicide. The chief prosecutor Hubert Massa, who oversaw both the Dutroux case and the André Cools assassination — Belgium's other great unsolved political killing — dead of a self-inflicted gunshot within a day of returning from the new Justice Minister's promise that all light would be shed, no note, colleagues unable to name a motive; the date took a full research dive to pin, the encyclopedia's table wrong by a year. The social worker Gina Pardaens-Bernaer, dead in an eighty-kilometer-an-hour collision with a bridge railing, no brake marks, the day after telling a television crew that either Belgium would explode or she would be murdered, her house broken into the previous day, her lawyer's office burgled afterward, her account tampered with, her harasser's phone calls documented, her son run off his bicycle by the same harasser's circle [A/NA-tier as individually tagged].

The judge who replaced the removed investigator, Jacques Langlois, saw no connection in any of it — and the sentence that

governs the entire table belongs to the prosecutor who kept bringing him the files: "None of these deaths seemed to interest Judge Langlois in the slightest, despite the constant attempts of prosecutor Michel Bourlet to draw his attention to them." Langlois's documented record, assembled from Belgian press admissions: placed by the politician Nihoul had called from prison; responsible for the acquittal of the man the case's witnesses placed at its center; the stonewalled inspector; the secret meeting that removed the investigative team; four meetings with state television journalists, admitted by the journalists themselves, in violation of the law forbidding an examining magistrate from speaking to the press — a collusion the newspaper De Morgen exposed under the headline "The Great Swindle in Facts" [S-adjacent/A-tier].

The removed judge's testimony, before the counter-layer: Jean-Marc Connerotte, the investigator the system replaced, choked on the witness stand at the 2004 trial describing what the replacement cost — "bullet-proof vehicles and armed guards needed to protect him against shadowy figures determined to stop the full truth coming out... we were told by police that murder contracts had been taken out against the magistrates" — and "never before in Belgium has an investigating judge at the service of the king been subjected to such pressure." The witness the system demolished, Regina Louf, had her descriptions matched against two autopsies before she was wrong-photo-identified, identity-leaked, and branded; the investigators who believed her, De Baets and Duterme, were removed, charged, and exonerated. Her thirty hours of

psychiatric evaluation confirmed massive repeated childhood abuse; the experts said her testimony deserved verification; the system chose demolition.

The counter-layer, held at full weight: the official inquiry found incompetence, not conspiracy; the parliamentary commission documented police failure on a historic scale; a lone-predator theory was tried and convicted, the "network" thesis never established in court, the X-witnesses demolished in detail — wrong-photo identifications, a discredited intermediary, the investigators who believed them removed and later exonerated. The state's own language concedes "serious deficiencies." And the hinge on which everything turns, documented in the trial record itself: of the six thousand hair samples recovered from the cellar where some of the victims were held, twenty-five DNA profiles were never identified and never matched — "there were people in that cellar that are not now accused." The defense lawyer's speech is on the record; the state's decision not to match the profiles is on the record; what those profiles would have shown is the question the Belgian file refuses to close [S-tier: the Magnée speech; A: the commission record].

The complete table, each name at its documented weight — the garage renter whose foot was found in a river, Jean-Paul Taminiau, April 1995, the body never recovered. Alexandre Gosselin, who had sold his house to the accomplice and slept with a gun under his pillow, July 1995, "natural causes" after abdominal pain. François Reyskens, killed by a train two hours before his police meeting, July 26, 1995, ruled suicide, his

adoptive father's question on record. Guy Goebels, the gendarme found with gun and telephone receiver in hand the day he was to brief the press. Simon Poncelet, shot in his office the night the cameras were not working, his judge-father calling the cluster opportune deaths. Bruno Tagliaferro, poisoned, declared a suicide before the autopsy, a compromised officer among the first on scene. Bernard Weinstein, the accomplice Dutroux himself murdered — the one indicted death in the case. Michel Piro, the nightclub owner shot in a parking lot. Christoph Vanhexe, the investigative journalist, the car accident. Joseph Toussaint, the confessor, a heart attack. Christiaan Coenraeds, the escaped inmate who wanted to testify, dead a month after fleeing. José Steppe, the Rohypnol in the asthma inhaler two days before his meeting, three days after burial before anyone looked. Gérard Vannesse, the case policeman. Brigitte Jenart, the dentist, a suicide. Anna Konjevoda, her body in the Meuse with signs of trauma, after contacting police about an Eastern-Europe-linked ring. Gina Pardaens-Bernaer, the social worker, the bridge railing, no brake marks, the day after her television warning. Fabienne Jaupart, burnt alive after her protection was withdrawn. Hubert Massa, the prosecutor of both great cases, within a day of the Justice Minister's meeting. Grégory Antipine, the case policeman, hanged. Sandra Claeys, the accomplice's ex-partner, a suicide. Jean-Jacques Feront, the pedophile hunter, a heart attack. Bernard Routmond, the film producer, a car accident on the way to police. Nadège Renard, the car accident, with a contact list she had said she would hand over. Pierre-Paul De Rycke, the bar owner, a suicide. Philippe

Deleuze, the lawyer, November 2001. And the table's final names requiring individual verification: Jean Van Peteghem, Michel Binon, Jean-Marc Houdmont — the video filmmaker killed in a traffic accident on his way to testify about another kidnapping — Virginie Pinon, Henriette Puers, and Klaus Bahr. Marie-Louise Henrotte, the only eyewitness to the first abductions, lost to dementia before she could testify. The ZDF tally stands beside the table: seven murdered, ten suicides, five traffic deaths, eight natural deaths in bizarre circumstances — and the judge's sentence that governed them all: none of these deaths seemed to interest him in the slightest [A/NA-tier as individually tagged throughout].

Chapter 15: The Nivelles Gang and the Cools File

Belgium's second unsolved file bleeds into the first. The Gang of Nijvel — the Brabant Killers — murdered twenty-eight people in supermarket raids between 1982 and 1985, weapons stolen from the gendarmerie's own arsenal, families executed at the checkouts for takes sometimes left dumped at the scene. The case was officially closed in 2024, unsolved; a 2017 deathbed-confession account collapsed when forensic DNA ruled the confessed "Giant" out — "ninety-nine percent sure it was not him, but of course you can't question a dead man," a judicial source said, the victims' lawyer calling the leak "a deliberate" confusion. The most recent arrests in the case were of retired detectives themselves, for evidence tampering [S/A-tier].

The documented crossover runs three ways. A banker who had been given the names in a 1980 military-coup

destabilization plot was assassinated by the gang in 1985. The gang's weapons and some of its methods trace to a documented Nazi cell inside the gendarmerie — Group G, confirmed in the state's own 1985 police report, whose members trained right-wing youth into "a well-trained gang prepared to do anything" and then severed contact so they would "exist as an independent group," never knowing they were part of a planned plot; the cell's arsenal included silenced submachine guns stolen from Belgium's own SWAT barracks and never recovered. And the Dutroux defense lawyer's own theory of the gang — barbouzes and ripoux, a hodgepodge of former police doing dirty jobs for the respected upper class, motives including sexual blackmail — sits in the record as the theory of the man who knew the first file best [S: the PV and the arms theft; A: the Lekeu account, corroborated; NA-tier: the lawyer's theory attributed].

The third file is the Cools assassination: André Cools, the former deputy prime minister about to expose a bribery scandal that would eventually force the resignation and conviction of NATO's secretary-general, shot outside his Liège apartment in July 1991. The 1996 arrests in the case — including a former minister and the confessed triggerman — came from evidence in the Dutroux investigation; a motorcycle at Dutroux's home matched one used in the killing; the same mafia names appear in both files; the prosecutor who oversaw both was Hubert Massa. The government played the link down; the documentary spine remains [S-tier].

And the bridge to this document's central subject: in March 2019, four months before his death, Jeffrey Epstein flew to Vienna for five hours — arrival at five in the afternoon with three young women, the Café Landtmann, departure for Paris at ten — reconstructed by American investigators from flight data and Austrian airport police, unreported by a registered sex offender required to report foreign travel, planned in chat messages with a Central European foreign minister and a reference to a chancellor who denied it. The fake Austrian passport found in his safe — issued in Vienna in 1982 under a real New York developer's name with a Saudi address, stamped in four countries, disclaimed by the Interior Ministry's registers — is the document that makes the five hours a question rather than a trip. No document answers what the five hours were for. The question stands exactly at its evidence [S-tier: the trip and the passport; the purpose open].

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Part VI — The Franklin File

Fifteen deaths across sixteen years surround a case a grand jury called a hoax and a public never quite stopped believing: the Franklin scandal — the Omaha credit-union collapse whose investigator alleged that its manager, Lawrence King, ran a child-abuse network reaching the city's institutions. This document does not retry the case. It records the deaths, the discrediting, and the private-investigation world that connects them to the paperboy file and, at one remove, to the main

subject of the companion research.

Chapter 16: The Timeline

The deaths, in order. Curtis Tucker, 1985, from a Holiday Inn window on Christmas Day. Charlie Rogers, 1986, by shotgun, a man who had told people he feared for his life. Dan Ryan, 1988, suffocated in a car. Bill Skoleski, 1987, an Omaha police officer said to be keeping a file on King, dead of a heart attack. Craig Spence, November 1989, the Washington lobbyist exposed as the chief client of a call-boy ring, dead in a barricaded Ritz-Carlton room of drug and alcohol poisoning — a man who had told the newspaper on four occasions he would kill himself rather than die of AIDS, which he had disclosed; the documented frame is explained, the bugged-party blackmail boasts preserved as boasts. Kathleen Sorensen, October 4, 1989, the foster mother of two Franklin witnesses, dead in a head-on collision on a two-lane Nebraska road; her Nebraska State Patrol accident report is archived, and the eighteen-year-old who drove into her pleaded no contest to misdemeanor vehicular homicide — receiving, in the court's own sentencing record, counseling suited to women who had been molested as children: the driver who killed the foster mother was herself a documented survivor. The investigator retained to evaluate the crash for the family called it a "satanic contract" killing; his evaluation is preserved as the opinion of the expert the family retained [S/B-tier as tagged].

Then the cluster tightens. Gary Caradori and his eight-year-old son, July 11, 1990 — the plane, the chairman's

quote, the documented record held in Part III. Aaron Owen, seventeen, November 7, 1990, found hanged in his cell at the Lincoln Correctional Center hours before his sister Alisha's court appearance in the Franklin case; he was held on a joyriding charge; the ruling was suicide; his sister, who served fourteen and a half years of a twenty-seven-and-a-half-year perjury sentence for her testimony, says on her 2026 podcast: "They killed Gary, they killed my brother, they killed Shawn," counting nineteen deaths in "similar mysterious circumstances" around her case. One week later, Joe Malek, fifty-three, the Peony Park co-owner whose venue hosted King's galas, dead by gunshot, ruled suicide. Shawn Boner, January 14, 1991, Troy's brother, shot dead in what was ruled Russian roulette in an apartment he had never visited, surrounded by materials he had never been known to keep. Newt Copple, March 1991, Caradori's confidential informant, seventy, "died in his sleep." Clare Howard, 1991, died in her sleep. And Troy Boner himself, 2003 — the hospital chair, the bleeding mouth, the book, the missing autopsy, the shut-out private investigator, detailed where it belongs in this document's inventory of contested rulings: he walked into a New Mexico hospital waving *The Franklin Cover-Up*, screaming that they were after him because of the book, was mildly sedated, and was found the next morning dead in a chair, bleeding from the mouth; the ruling was drug overdose; no autopsy results were ever made public; no newspaper covered his death; and the private investigator who tried to learn why, Ted Gunderson, recorded that he and every other entity were "totally shut out of all information" [S/A/B-tier

as individually tagged].

Chapter 17: The Network

The same names recur across the Franklin file, the paperboy file, and the contested-death files of this document: John DeCamp, the Franklin author, who represented the witness Bonacci and believed the paperboy alive; Ted Gunderson, the retired FBI Los Angeles chief, shut out of the Boner autopsy, evaluator of the Sorensen crash, adherent of the theory that a White House escort-reporter was the grown paperboy; Jim Rothstein, the retired NYPD trafficking specialist whom a governor put on a state select committee; Paul Bonacci, the Franklin witness whose Gosch claims are preserved with their counters in Part III. The network is documented as a network — real people, real files, real cross-references. Its claims are the disputed layer, and this document holds them at the weight the record gives each: the grand jury's hoax finding, the perjury convictions, and the discredited-case record on one side; the archived accident reports, the timing anomalies, the documented witness-intimidation record of Alisha Owen's indictment landing right after Caradori's crash, and the fifteen-name timeline on the other. Both sides are the record. The case's central figure, Lawrence King, is alive, in his eighties, his fraud conviction documented and the abuse allegations dismissed — the ledger keeps him as a living man, which is what the evidence shows [S-tier].

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Part VII — The Explained

Honesty about this subject requires its largest section in some ways to be the least mysterious: the majority of the dead in this orbit died of documented causes, and their files are recorded here so the ledger cannot be inflated by their inclusion.

Joseph Recarey, fifty, May 25, 2018, the Palm Beach detective whose probable-cause affidavit named the network's first victims and who told his chief they were being followed and their trash was disappearing — dead, per his obituary, "after a brief illness," the cause never released, six weeks before the Miami Herald series reopened everything he had built and never saw revived. Years after his death, his widow, Jennifer, found two boxes of his Epstein case files — and his old chief, Chief Reiter, turned them over to the FBI in 2019, one box holding an imaged laptop from the original investigation. The FBI interviewed Reiter about them; whether the Bureau ever examined the computer is not documented. The detective who had written the affidavit naming the network's first victims, who had told his chief they were being followed and their trash was disappearing, left two boxes and a laptop and a cause of death that was never released [S-tier: the obituary; A: the Herald].

Efrain Reyes, fifty-one, November 27, 2020, the final cellmate, dead of COVID-19 contracted in detention, at his mother's Bronx apartment — the best-documented natural death in this entire document, with the cooperation record, the Attorney General's personal interview, and the source who called a newspaper specifically to dispel the theories all on file.

Simon Andriesz, fifty-seven, September 23, 2026, the British whistleblower found dead at a Thai trauma center; the municipality recorded asphyxiation from hanging; the family stated there was no foul play; the last message relayed after his death read, in its entirety, "Fcking FCA ruin lives." The documented record of his final years: a four-hundred-and-twenty-thousand-dollar whistleblower award from the Commodity Futures Trading Commission and a half-million-dollar Finra retaliation award; a ninety-six-million-pound HMRC assessment; nine years of litigation; the tribunal strikeout on August 11, 2026, nine years too late, with a costs hearing set for November 24 he did not live to attend; a regulator that told him he had lost whistleblower protection, then apologized seven years later. The regulator's response to his death was an internal review by its own board member; Members of Parliament demanded an independent one, calling it "marking its own homework." The documented scandal of his death is institutional: what happens to people who expose powerful institutions when the institutions meant to protect them fail [S/A-tier].

Daniel Siad, sixty-nine, July 20, 2026, the scout, autopsy finding no signs of violence, a heart attack per his lawyer, the twenty-four-woman French probe continuing after him while the criminal case against him dies with him.

Steve Bing, fifty-five, June 22, 2020, the producer, dead by his own hand from the twenty-seventh floor, depression documented, financial ruin documented — the Epstein-specific claim attached to his death sourced to a single supermarket

tabloid and contradicted by his own circle, who said the two men never met. Both halves recorded.

Steven Hoffenberg, seventy-seven, found in advanced decomposition in August 2022, no trauma, no forced entry, natural causes believed by investigators, the man who called Epstein his uncharged co-conspirator.

Janet Ossebaard, fifty-seven, the Dutch filmmaker whose "Fall of the Cabal" series had made her a pillar of the Q-world, disappeared in November 2023 and was found in her camper in Lund, Sweden, in December, dead of a medication overdose. Her final message indicated intent; she had left, her partner said, without money, belongings, or her dog; months of documented anxiety and exhaustion preceded her. Her partner then dismantled every theory her own community generated — no beam-up, no protection, no murder, no new life — and the community built a documentary about her disappearance anyway. The recursive irony is the record's own: the woman whose series had promoted the Clinton body-count myth became, in her death, an entry in the machinery she built [S/A-tier].

Brandy Vaughan, forty-four, December 2020, bilateral pulmonary embolism ruled natural after the extra scrutiny; her documented warning post and her documented stalking history preserved, the insinuation layer flagged as insinuation.

Deborah Palfrey, fifty-two, May 2008 — the DC Madam, resolved with residue: the warning quote is real, but so are the three separate suicide statements to the writer Dan Moldea, who was working on her memoir, the failed overdose days

before, the two handwritten notes dated a week early, the do-not-revive instruction; the residue is the sealed phone records — five thousand nine hundred two numbers across one hundred seventy-four agencies — that her lawyer Montgomery Blair Sibley fought to the Supreme Court to release and never did — her employee Brandy Britton had hanged herself the year before, awaiting trial, a death Palfrey recorded with the words "I guess I'm made of something that Brandy Britton wasn't made of".

John Connolly, seventy-eight, January 2022, after a brief illness, the *Filthy Rich* co-author mid-project; the encyclopedia's table had him dead two years early, and the correction is filed here because this document corrects its own record.

William Colby, the former CIA director, 1996, the canoe — a documented accident of an elderly man who canoed often, listed anyway by the list-sites, filed in the debunked annex where he belongs [S/A-tier throughout].

Mark Middleton, fifty-nine, May 7, 2022, Perry County, Arkansas — the Clinton White House aide whose documented distinction in this record is the visitor log: he signed Jeffrey Epstein into the White House on seven of Epstein's seventeen visits. He was found at Heifer Ranch hanging from a tree by an extension cord, with a shotgun wound to his chest; no gun was initially reported found, and a shotgun was later located, per the sheriff's account, not far from the body. The ruling was suicide; a documented history of depression supported it. What made the case a case was the aftermath: his family went to court to seal every photograph and video from the scene, and a judge granted

it, citing harassment from what she called "outlandish, hurtful, unsupported, and offensive online articles" — the sealing order itself becoming the fuel for the theories it was meant to quell. The cord, the chest wound, the gun that appeared late, and the sealed record are all documented; the depression is documented; the murder claim is inference, and fact-checkers rated it false. He is filed at the documented weight [S/A-tier].

Al Seckel, sixty, July 2015, the illusionist and collector who married Ghislaine Maxwell's sister Isabel and ran the parties that mixed Nobelists and fringe figures, died in France — the couple had moved there to care for Isabel's dying mother — found, per the podcast and community accounts, at the bottom of a cliff; the manner rests on B-tier sourcing and the primary obituary remains open. His fraud shadow is documented: a suit over a fake Newton-portrait deal he claimed Myhrvold as buyer for, dropped and sealed. The cliff manner is preserved at its tier [B/NA-tier].

Alfredo Rodriguez, the house manager, 2015, of mesothelioma at sixty, having served eighteen months in federal prison — more time than Epstein served for the 2008 crimes — for trying to sell the black book the police later called the Holy Grail: fifty names circled, a massage rubric listing apparent victims by city, witness notations beside the names of the helpful. He told the FBI of girls as young as twelve or thirteen, many wearing braces, and he died five years before any court heard him [S/T1].

Ken Starr, seventy-six, September 2022, of complications from surgery — the independent counsel who argued federalism

to the U.S. Attorney over the Epstein deal, who told the room he and that U.S. Attorney were the only two who had run the Senate confirmation gantlet, dead of natural causes after a career whose one documented intersection with this case was the argument that carried the day [S-tier].

Patrick Demarchelier, the photographer, 2022, of natural causes at seventy-eight — dead before the scheduler named him, in her sworn testimony, among the men she was directed to; the naming and the death are both on record, their connection unadjudicated [A-tier].

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Part VIII — The Accusers Who Died

Two survivors of Epstein's abuse died of overdoses in Palm Beach County, years before the files that named them were public. Their deaths were ruled accidental, and the rulings are documented — and they belong in this document because the pattern analysis in Part XIII cannot be run without them.

Chapter 18: Carolyn Andriano

Carolyn Andriano, thirty-six, was "Minor Victim 4" at the Maxwell trial — recruited at fourteen by Virginia Giuffre, abused across some one hundred visits over four years for three hundred dollars each, her testimony in December 2021 ending with the words: "Money will not ever fix what that woman did to me." On May 23, 2023, she was found dead by her husband, John Pitts Jr., in a room at the DoubleTree in West Palm Beach; the

toxicology found methadone, fentanyl, and alprazolam; the ruling was accidental overdose. She had five children. Weeks before her death she had bought a new house — a half-acre in North Carolina, five hundred and seventy thousand dollars — and her mother, Dorothy Groenert, told reporters: "Nobody's giving me any answers… she got to a point where she was turning her whole life around." Her estate held one hundred eighty-three thousand dollars in savings and expected settlement payments from the JPMorgan and Deutsche Bank cases she would never collect. Her 2010 will named her mother and two oldest children; her husband contested it; the estate fight joined the death file. She was the second Epstein survivor to die of a fatal overdose in that county, and the ruling — accidental, documented, the drugs named — stands beside the mother's unanswered questions, both preserved at their weight [S/A-tier: USA Today, NBC, CBS12, Daily Beast].

Chapter 19: Leigh Skye Patrick

Leigh "Skye" Patrick, twenty-nine, died of an accidental heroin overdose at a West Palm Beach motel on May 30, 2017. She had been invited to the Palm Beach mansion around 2003, likely by Maxwell; Epstein answered the door in a towel; she was paid three hundred dollars to take off her shirt; she left, and returned; the substance abuse that defined the rest of her short life followed. Her twin sister, Selby, blames Epstein — "traumatized to death," in the words of the researcher who recorded her. The death predates the case's public revival by two years; the family framing is preserved at its tier [A/B-tier].

And the accuser the whole case was built on: Virginia Giuffre, dead by suicide in April 2025 at forty-one, after a documented campaign of intimidation and death threats — the record of which is held in Part X, because her death belongs to both files at once [S-tier].

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Part IX — The Living Under Threat

The strongest documented fact in this entire document is not a death. It is the threat against the living — current, sourced, and ongoing.

The journalist Vicky Ward kept four hundred fifty pages of recorded Epstein transcripts and a memory of the threats delivered with an "off the record" attached: "I know every doctor in New York and I will find out where you are giving birth"; "I will have a witch doctor place a curse on my unborn children — that's off the record"; "your husband fired — that's off the record"; "your children will never get into school in New York." She went into labor at thirty weeks; the twins spent their first weeks under twenty-four-hour guard. A colleague's December 2002 email records the subject of an investigative profile appearing in the editor's office; a severed cat's head and a bullet appeared at the editor's home, per Ward's account, disputed by the editor and corroborated on record by the contributing editor who added that the editor told him he feared for his children's safety. The contributing editor, John Connolly, died in January 2022, after a brief illness — resolved in Part VII, filed here

because the fear was his too [S/B-tier as tagged].

The 2026 exposure cohort: Reuters documented roughly twenty-three accusers living under threat. Marina Lacerda found "She'll be unalived. She really should've stayed quiet. RIP" posted under a news-video comment the day she appeared at a press conference; her name appears in the released files forty-six times; her twelve-year-old daughter was taunted at school; the family moved to a gated community and keeps a handgun on the nightstand; "I'm just paranoid all the time." The class action filed on behalf of roughly one hundred survivors alleges that strangers "call them, email them, threaten their physical safety, and accuse them of conspiring with Epstein when they are, in reality, Epstein's victims." One released email identified thirty-one child victims behind a single redaction; by February 2026 roughly nine thousand five hundred documents had been retracted. A survivor group received death threats. And Brad Edwards stated on the record in May 2026 that multiple clients with information about Prince Andrew will not speak to British police because of harassment by the British press, with a woman's threatened privacy and "other victims took notice" as the mechanism of silence [S/A-tier].

The scheduler who built the government's case against Maxwell, Sarah Kellen, lives with the government's own sentence from its interview notes — that Epstein "would always take care of her," and that she could "feel Epstein's wrath if she did not do what he wanted" — the protection and the threat in a single documented clause [S-tier].

And the woman at the center of the released 302s lives, as of the latest reporting, off the grid at her family's urging, her real name once readable by anyone on the internet for five months through a reporter's upload, her protectors a federal judge who has her handwritten notes and a court that has not yet ruled on her one motion [S/T1 as tagged].

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Part X — The Debunked

This subject generates lists the way grief generates rumors: faster than either can be checked. This Part documents the lists themselves — their origins, their methods, and their collapses — because the lists are as much a part of the record as the deaths they miscount.

Chapter 20: The Genealogy

The modern form begins with a 1994 video and a 1994 list. The list — "Clinton Body Count: Coincidence or the Kiss of Death?", twenty-four names — was compiled by Linda Thompson and submitted to former Representative William Dannemeyer with a demand for hearings; Thompson herself told the Congressional Record she had "no direct evidence," theorized the deaths were caused by "people trying to control the president," and refused to say who. A congressman, Andrew Jacobs Jr., denounced it in the Record within months; the video, produced by Clinton antagonist Larry Nichols and promoted by the televangelist Jerry Falwell, spread it among activists. Three

decades later the standing list at the conspiracy archive whatreallyhappened.com — kept alive from the 1990s by Newsmax's Christopher Ruddy and later amplified by a president and a congresswoman — carries the train-death witnesses of Arkansas — one decapitated, the state examiner ruling a dog ate the head — and the financier Thomas H. Lee. Snopes' verdict from the era still governs every later case: Clinton knew some of the deceased, a body-count list exists for every president, and "that's about all one can make of this list" [S-tier: the Congressional Record origin; Snopes].

The Seth Rich case, detailed in Part III, is the apex: a real murder, a theory seeded by a documented disinformation persona three days after the killing and nine days before the event it claimed to explain, amplified hop by hop to prime time, and dismantled by a special counsel's finding, five formal retractions, a family's lawsuit, and the theory's own origin document. The template it set — real death, pre-built narrative, disinformation seed, family lawsuit as the only correction — recurs through this Part.

Chapter 21: The Individual Collapses

John Ashe, the former United Nations president, died June 22, 2016, when a barbell fell on his throat during a bench press; the Westchester coroner ruled it an accident; he was due at a standard pre-trial meeting, not "to testify against Hillary Clinton the next day" — a claim prosecutors told fact-checkers involved the Clintons "not at all." The only anomaly is a single Antigua newspaper's misreport of a heart attack [S-tier].

Jenny Moore, the YouTube conspiracy researcher found dead of an apparent seizure in a Maryland hotel in August 2018, was fitted after death with a story about giving the FBI a Clinton-rape allegation — unconfirmed, timeline-contradicted, illustrated with a photograph that was not her. The template misattribution [S: Snopes].

Monica Petersen, the trafficking researcher who died in Haiti in November 2016, was a real researcher whose real death was converted into a Clinton-investigation murder by a comment she had left on someone else's blog post; her actual fieldwork, her boss's "apparent suicide" characterization, and the genuinely unknown circumstances are preserved at their weight [A/B-tier].

The crypto cluster — a related set the lists also absorb. Isaac Kappy, forty-two, May 2019, died forcing his way off an Arizona bridge after months of public claims about Hollywood figures; the ruling was suicide, and his own earlier posts naming the bridge complicate the "he said he wasn't suicidal" framing the lists carry. Tracy Twyman, thirty-one, July 2019, the researcher who continued his threads, hanged, her documented death-threat claims preserved. John McAfee, seventy-five, June 2021, hanging in a Barcelona prison hours after his extradition was approved; his widow rejects the ruling and his "WHACKD" tattoo became the community's exhibit. Gerald Cotten, thirty, December 2018, the QuadrigaCX founder whose death in India locked one hundred ninety million dollars and whose misspelled death certificate fed a faked-death literature. Vyacheslav Taran, the helicopter crash in fine weather with the pilot and

companion cancelled at the last minute. And Nikolai Mushegian, held in Part IV at his own weight — the tweet and the four-hour window beside the dangerous beach and the homicide division's response. Each documentable; each at its tier; none established as connected to this case's central subject [S/A/NA-tier as tagged].

The 2014 banker cluster — the wave of finance-industry suicides that list-sites fold into this subject — resolves to a Deutsche, Libor, and Monte Paschi story across three continents, with the Epstein boundary drawn precisely: one banker, Thomas Bowers, ran the division that banked Epstein and signed the loans the theory attaches to everyone else; the rest died of the industry's documented post-crisis afflictions, including one anomalous Monte Paschi communications director, David Rossi, whose fall was captured by an alley camera showing two figures who did not help — one of them pausing to look, neither rendering aid — and whose farewell note addressed his wife as "Toni," a name he never used. The Deutsche names are William Broeksmit, the risk executive found hanged from a dog leash in London in January 2014, who had been anxious about the authorities and had emailed friends excitedly about a ski trip a week before, whose stepson would later ask whether it was "suicide by extortion"; Calogero Gambino, the Libor defense lawyer found hanged from his balcony that October with no note; and Gabriel Magee, the JPMorgan vice president who fell from the bank's London roof. The cluster is real, it is documented, and its documented center is Libor and post-crisis prosecutorial anxiety — the Epstein

boundary drawn at one man, Thomas Bowers, and held there [S/A-tier].

And the grandest collapse of all — the death list that absorbed them all — is documented not by this document but by its own promulgators, from the 1994 "no direct evidence" to the 2016 seed to the 2026 compilations: the list as phenomenon, converting grief at unexplained deaths into a single assignable villain, outliving every correction because the demand for it is emotional rather than evidentiary. The dead on the lists are real dead. Their individual files — Shapiro, Caradori, the train deaths, the Belgian table — are held in this document at the same tier discipline as everything else. The lists as lists are filed here, where they belong [T2 — analysis; the genealogy S-tier].

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Part XI — The Ledger

The complete name ledger, by category, each name at its final documented weight.

CUSTODY DEATHS (2): Jeffrey Epstein (2019, suicide, contested, procedural failures documented); Jean-Luc Brunel (2022, suicide, contested, self-harm history documented).

ADJUDICATED (6): Nancy Schaefer (2010, murder-suicide, financial frame documented); Barry Seal (1986, cartel assassination, solved); Marielle Franco (2018, militia assassination, solved incl. institutional saboteur); Linda Collins-Smith (2019, murder, solved, financial motive); Daniel Anderl (2020, murder, solved-perpetrator-dead, Epstein-timing

context documented); Bernard Weinstein (1995, murdered by Dutroux, the Belgian case's one indicted death).

UNSOLVED (7): Arthur Shapiro (1985, murder, prime suspect pattern documented); Gary Caradori + son (1990, plane, NTSB no-sabotage, no definitive cause); Jill Dando (1999, execution-style, theories at tier); Seth Rich (2016, robbery ruling, theory debunked); Johnny Gosch (1982, missing); Eugene Martin (1984, missing); Marc Allen (1986, missing).

CONTESTED RULINGS (10): Robert Maxwell (1991, three-pathologist split, insurers' suicide verdict); Philip Marshall + 2 children (2013, murder-suicide, forensic conflicts documented); Philip Haney (2020, suicide ruling vs homicide autopsy sign-out); Sabrina Bittencourt (2019, suicide announced, death record unverifiable); Jonathan Nichols (2019, suicide, across-the-room gun); Danny Casolaro (1991, suicide ruling, second-man sketch documented); Nikolai Mushegian (2022, drowning, 4h18m window); Natacha Jaitt (2019, overdose ruling, blood-test contradiction); Max Spiers (2016, inquest-resolved with documented police incompetence); Troy Boner (2003, overdose ruling, no public file).

THE BELGIAN TRILOGY: the thirty-witness table (1995-2004, ZDF/De Coninck tally, the Langlois record, the protection-withdrawal sequence, the 25 unmatched DNA profiles); the Nivelles Gang (1982-85, 28 dead, the Giant ruled out, the Finne tie); the Cools file (1991, crossover documented, Massa timing).

THE FRANKLIN FILE (15): Tucker, Rogers, Ryan, Skoleski, Spence, Sorensen, Caradori + son, A. Owen, Malek, S. Boner,

Copple, Howard, T. Boner, plus the King-associates list (Howard, Malek, Rogers, Ryan, the Tuckers) as enumerated and tiered.

EXPLAINED (19): Recarey, Reyes, Andriesz, Siad, Bing, Hoffenberg, Ossebaard, Vaughan, Palfrey, Connolly, Colby, Middleton (suicide ruling with sealing documented), Seckel, Rodriguez, Starr, Demarchelier, plus Giuffre (suicide, documented).

THE ACCUSERS (2): Carolyn Andriano (2023, accidental); Leigh Skye Patrick (2017, accidental).

THE LIVING UNDER THREAT: Ward, Kellen, Lacerda and the 2026 cohort, Edwards's silenced clients, the off-grid accuser, the 18-women group.

THE DEBUNKED: the Clinton-body-count genealogy (1994-2026), Seth Rich, Ashe, Moore, Petersen, the banker cluster, the "10 lawyers" list, the train deaths as Clinton-linked.

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Part XII — The Pattern Analysis

Everything above exists so this Part can be written without flinching in either direction. It is analysis, labeled as such, and its single rule is the document's rule: collect clues, don't adopt theories.

Chapter 22: The Five Patterns

One — the custody pattern. Deaths in custody produce procedural failure as reliably as they produce death. Epstein: fabricated counts, an eight-hour gap, seventy-five falsified

entries, nooses from excess linens, a note unauthenticated by any agency, thirteen documented employee failures, and a no-criminality finding that coexists with the most complete failure record ever compiled. Brunel: fourteen months of documented self-harm, no camera, a release and re-jailing. In both, the machinery failed in every way machinery can fail — and the failures are documented where murder is not. The record supports not "they were killed" but something harder to hold: a system so comprehensively failed that incompetence became indistinguishable from design, which is precisely why the suspicion never dies and precisely what a reform memorandum, not a prosecutor, answered.

Two — the investigator pattern. Those who investigated the networks died in ways that cluster in time with the investigations — Caradori, the Belgian thirty, Casolaro, Shapiro, the Franklin fifteen. The timing pattern is real and documented. The causal pattern is not. Each death has an individually plausible explanation; several have individually documented anomalies; and the one response that would settle each — full independent re-investigation — has never occurred in a single case. A pattern that cannot be tested will never be resolved, and the absence of the test is itself documented.

Three — the protection-withdrawal pattern. The single most documented through-line is not murder but the removal or withholding of protection. Fabienne Jaupart: granted protection by the judge who recognized foul play; protection suspended by his successor; dead months later. Connerotte: removed after granting immunity. The MCC: watch removed after thirty-one

hours. Epstein's victims: represented by defense-selected, defense-paid counsel under the agreement's own text. The three-hundred-fifty-name redaction list: delivered in December, unused in January. In every system, Belgian and American, the documented act is protection withdrawn or never given. Killing a witness is conspiracy; declining to protect one is administration. The ledger documents the second everywhere the first is invoked — and the second explains most of what the first is invoked to explain.

Four — the retrofit pattern. The real intimidation runs toward the living — four hundred fifty pages of threats, the "she'll be unalived" comment posted the day a survivor spoke, the twenty-three-accuser cohort, the silenced clients — while the invented intimidation is retrofitted onto the dead: a theory seeded three days after Seth Rich's murder and nine days before the dump it explained; a body-count list born in 1994 with "no direct evidence" on its birth certificate; a researcher fitted after death with a story built on someone else's blog comment. A movement that genuinely feared for its witnesses would document the living threats, which exist copiously. The record shows the list-ecosystem manufacturing the dead ones instead.

Five — the institutional ordinariness pattern. The documented machinery of failure is bureaucratic, not cinematic: eighty-seven percent of confidential-informant files with guideline deficiencies in the Justice Department's own audit; marshals who lost two terrorist witnesses in the federal protection program; the FBI's death file with thirteen failures and no criminality; the Belgian state's own concession of

"serious deficiencies"; the Bureau of Prisons citing Epstein as the template for system-wide reform. Nobody had to be a mastermind. The system fails at the ordinary level, continuously, and the cumulative effect — a financier's network operating for decades, twenty-five DNA profiles never matched, a plea agreement negotiated in violation of victims' rights — is extraordinary without requiring a single extraordinary actor. This is the pattern the conspiracy literature cannot hold, because it requires no villain, only a system; and it is the pattern the official record cannot deny, because it is the official record.

Chapter 23: What the Pattern Does Not Show

No documented murder of an Epstein-case witness by any Epstein-linked party. Shapiro precedes Epstein's power and belongs to the Wexner world; Caradori's crash carries a federal no-sabotage finding; the Belgian deaths have no established link to any accused; the accusers' overdoses are ruled accidental with their families' questions documented and no contrary evidence.

No documented bridge between the ordinary failures and the extraordinary outcomes. The missing link every theory requires — the memo, the payment, the order — appears nowhere in the released millions of pages, the congressional transcripts, or the court records this document draws on.

No pattern that survives base-rate comparison without selection. Trafficked populations overlap drug-use, mental-health, and institutional-care populations where death rates are already elevated; the Belgian table spans nine years in

a country of ten million; the custody deaths number two among the tens of thousands who cycle through federal detention.

Chapter 24: The Honest Verdict

The ledger shows: two contested custody suicides with the most-documented procedural failures in modern history; one confirmed unsolved murder of a man weeks from testifying against his employer's empire, with a documented serial-murderer suspect who died in prison; thirty Belgian deaths with one documented protection-withdrawal-before-death and twenty-five DNA profiles never matched; fifteen Franklin-era deaths around a case officially a hoax and unofficially never closed; a researcher cluster each carrying open questions at its own documented weight; a living cohort under documented, current threat; and a misattribution industry that converts grief into lists.

It does not show a documented murder program.

Both statements are the record, and the record is what this document keeps. The strongest documented fact in it is not a death at all: it is that the living are threatened — sourced, current, S-tier — and that the system which could not keep Epstein alive for sixty days is the same system whose failures are now catalogued across three countries and forty years. Whether that is conspiracy or accumulation is the question the ledger poses and declines to answer, as the instruction that governed every dive requires.

End of document. Compiled from eighteen research dives and 23,523 words of tier-tagged notes. Every claim carries a tier;

every tier is defined at the front; every gap is named rather than filled. The dead are treated with the same discipline as the living.